

UPSC INDIAN POLITY

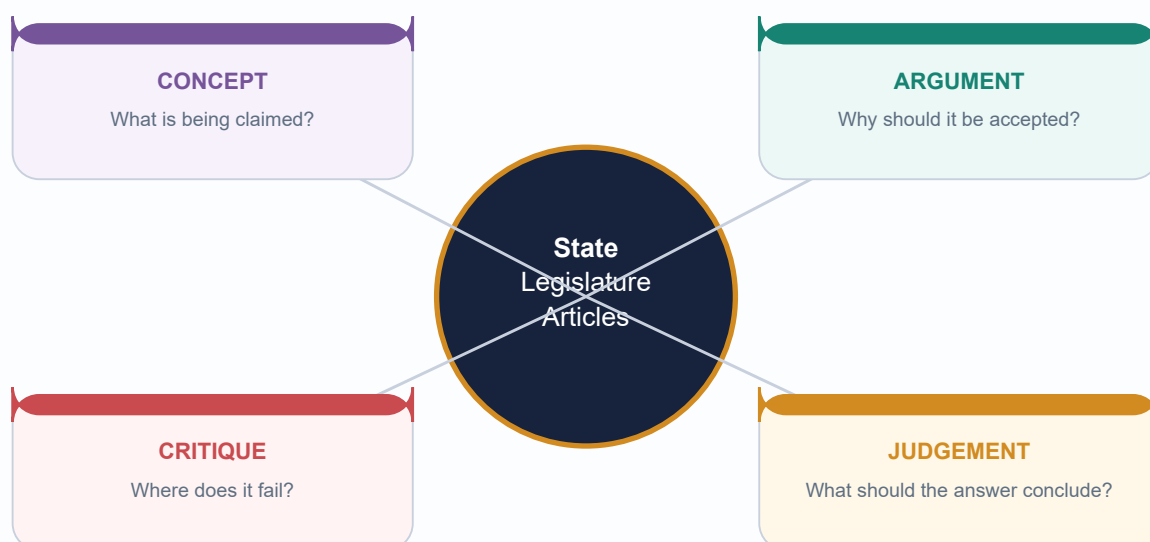
State Legislature (Articles 168–212) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: State-Legislature.md + 20_State-Legislature.md

Learning cards: 19



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Basic · **GS Paper:** GS-II · **Grounded in:** Laxmikant Ch. 33.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

• greater than □ book · □□ inference · □ current. *Depth version: advanced/20_State-Legislature.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than book · □□ inference · □ current. *Depth version: advanced/20_State-Legislature.md.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core
Foundation

HIGH

Foundation • Snapshot

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha)	Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad)
Nature	□ Lower/popular, directly elected	□ Upper, indirect + nominated , permanent
Strength	□ Normally 60–500 , with special constitutional/statutory exceptions for smaller states	□ max 1/3 of Assembly, min 40
Term	5 yrs, dissolvable (like LS)	Permanent, 1/3 retire every 2 yrs (like RS)
Articles	168–212	

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Most states are **unicameral**; only **6 are bicameral** — AP, Telangana, UP, Bihar, Maharashtra, Karnataka. A Council can be **created or abolished** (Art 169) by Parliament (simple majority) if the **Assembly passes a special-majority resolution** — it is **not** a constitutional amendment.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

Dimension 1

□ Most states are unicameral; only 6 are bicameral — AP, Telangana, UP, Bihar, Maharashtra, Karnataka. A Council can be created or abolished (Art 169)

Dimension 2

greater than □ Council composition (1/3–1/12–1/12–1/3–1/6): local bodies 1/3, graduates 1/12, teachers

Dimension 3

greater than 1/12, MLAs 1/3, Governor nominates 1/6. → 5/6 elected + 1/6 nominated.

STATIC THEORY

- greater than □ **Council composition (1/3–1/12–1/12–1/3–1/6)**: local bodies **1/3**, graduates **1/12**, teachers
- greater than **1/12**, MLAs **1/3**, Governor nominates **1/6**. → 5/6 elected + 1/6 nominated.

MEMORY HOOK

greater than Council composition (1/3–1/12–1/12–1/3–1/6): local bodies 1/3, graduates 1/12, teachers

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Most states are **unicameral**; only **6 are bicameral** — AP, Telangana, UP, Bihar, Maharashtra, Karnataka. A Council can be **created or abolished** (Art 169) by Parliament (simple majority) if the **Assembly passes a special-majority resolution** — it is **not** a constitutional amendment.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · The Council is weak — remember

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Only a **dilatory chamber** (delays ordinary bills max **4 months**), NOT a revising body like the Rajya Sabha. Money bill only in the **Assembly**; Council **can't** vote grants or pass a no-confidence motion. Its existence depends on the Assembly.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Only a **dilatory chamber** (delays ordinary bills max **4 months**), NOT a revising body like the Rajya Sabha. Money bill only in the **Assembly**; Council **can't** vote grants or pass a no-confidence motion. Its existence depends on the Assembly.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → The Council is
weak — remember

HIGH**Foundation · Must-Know Facts**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ 6 bicameral states (mnemonic: **KATBUM** — Karnataka, AP, Telangana, Bihar, UP, Maharashtra).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP**Must-Know Facts****Dimension 1**

□ 6 bicameral states (mnemonic: KATBUM — Karnataka, AP, Telangana, Bihar, UP, Maharashtra).

Dimension 2

□ CoM is responsible only to the Assembly.

Dimension 3

□ Council members elected by STV proportional representation.

Dimension 4

□ Readjustment remains deferred until relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026

STATIC THEORY

- □ CoM is responsible **only to the Assembly**.
- □ Council members elected by **STV proportional representation**.
- □ Readjustment remains deferred until relevant figures of the ****first census taken after 2026**
- have been published** (84th Amdt); there is no automatic 2026 delimitation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 6 bicameral states (mnemonic: **KATBUM** — Karnataka, AP, Telangana, Bihar, UP, Maharashtra).
2. CoM is responsible **only to the Assembly**.
3. Council members elected by **STV proportional representation**.
4. Readjustment remains deferred until relevant figures of the ****first census taken after 2026**

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know
Facts

HIGH

Foundation • Current linkGS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

  Proposals to **create or abolish Legislative Councils** keep resurfacing in various states — a live **Article 169** debate.   Full Council-vs-Assembly contrast, traps & Mains angles: **advanced/20_State-Legislature.md**

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of  Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —

ADVANCED / COMPLETE →  Current link

HIGH

Advanced • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation



Dimension 1

greater than Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) ·
GS Paper: GS-II

Dimension 2

greater than Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch.
33 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

Dimension 3

greater than  = from source book ·  = inference / case
law ·  = current affairs.

Dimension 4

greater than Companion: basic/State-Legislature.md.

STATIC THEORY

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- greater than  = from source book ·  = inference / case law ·  = current affairs.
- greater than *Companion: basic/State-Legislature.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core
Foundation

HIGH**Advanced · PART A — ORGANISATION**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ **No uniformity** — most states are **unicameral** (Governor + Legislative Assembly); only **6 are bicameral** (Governor + Legislative Council + Assembly): **Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Maharashtra, Karnataka. J&K Council abolished** (Reorganisation Act 2019); Tamil Nadu's 2010 Council Act never enforced.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **No uniformity** — most states are **unicameral** (Governor + Legislative Assembly); only **6 are bicameral** (Governor + Legislative Council + Assembly): **Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Maharashtra, Karnataka. J&K Council abolished** (Reorganisation Act 2019); Tamil Nadu's 2010 Council Act never enforced.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A —
ORGANISATION

HIGH**Advanced · Abolition/Creation of a Council (Art 169) □**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ Parliament can **create/abolish** a Legislative Council if the state **Assembly passes a special-majority resolution**; such an Act is **NOT a constitutional amendment** (Art 368) and passes by **simple majority** in Parliament. History: AP created 1957 → abolished 1985 → revived 2007; TN abolished 1986; Punjab & WB 1969.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Parliament can **create/abolish** a Legislative Council if the state **Assembly passes a special-majority resolution**; such an Act is **NOT a constitutional amendment** (Art 368) and passes by **simple majority** in Parliament. History: AP created 1957 → abolished 1985 → revived 2007; TN abolished 1986; Punjab & WB 1969.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE →
Abolition/Creation of a Council (Art 169) □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — COMPOSITION

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PART B — COMPOSITION.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B —
COMPOSITION

HIGH

Advanced · Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha) □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Directly elected**, universal adult franchise; normally **60–500**, with special constitutional/statutory exceptions for smaller states (current examples: **Sikkim 32, Goa 40, Mizoram 40**). Figures such as 30/40/46 in special Articles are constitutional minima, not necessarily the present Assembly strength. Governor's Anglo-Indian nomination power lapsed under the 104th Amendment. Readjustment remains deferred until the relevant figures of the **first census taken after 2026 have been published** (84th Amdt); SC/ST reservation is based on population ratio.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Directly elected**, universal adult franchise; normally **60–500**, with special constitutional/statutory exceptions for smaller states (current examples: **Sikkim 32, Goa 40, Mizoram 40**). Figures such as 30/40/46 in special Articles are constitutional minima, not necessarily the present Assembly strength. Governor's Anglo-Indian nomination power lapsed under the 104th Amendment. Readjustment remains deferred until the relevant figures of the **first census taken after 2026 have been published** (84th Amdt); SC/ST reservation is based on population ratio.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Legislative
Assembly (Vidhan Sabha) □

HIGH

Advanced · Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Fraction	Electorate
□ 1/3	members of local bodies
□ 1/12	graduates (3 yrs standing)
□ 1/12	teachers (3 yrs standing)
□ 1/3	elected by MLAs (from non-members)
□ 1/6	nominated by Governor (literature, science, art, cooperative movement, social service)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
 ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Legislative
 Council (Vidhan Parishad) □

HIGH

Advanced • Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Indirectly elected / partly nominated**; strength = **max 1/3 of Assembly, min 40**. Composition:

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

• So 5/6 indirectly elected + 1/6 nominated, via **STV** proportional representation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Indirectly elected / partly nominated**; strength = **max 1/3 of Assembly, min 40**. Composition:

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
 ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Legislative
 Council (Vidhan Parishad) □

HIGH

Advanced • Duration

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Assembly** — 5-yr term, dissolvable (like LS). **Council** — **permanent**, 1/3 retire every 2 yrs, 6-yr term (like RS).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Assembly** — 5-yr term, dissolvable (like LS). **Council** — **permanent**, 1/3 retire every 2 yrs, 6-yr term (like RS).

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Duration

HIGH**Advanced · PART C — COUNCIL vs ASSEMBLY (the key contrast) □ · Part 1**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ **Equal**: ordinary bills, ordinance approval, choosing ministers/CM, considering constitutional-body reports. □ **Unequal (Assembly dominates)**:

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — COUNCIL VS ASSEMBLY (THE KEY CONTRAST) □: RECALL MAP**PART C — COUNCIL vs ASSEMBLY (the key contrast) □**

Dimension 1 □ Equal: ordinary bills, ordinance approval, choosing ministers/CM, considering constitutional-body reports. □ Unequal (Assembly dominates):	Dimension 2 Money bill only in the Assembly; Council only recommends, returns in 14 days; Speaker certifies.
Dimension 3 Ordinary bill: Council can only delay 4 months (3 + 1) → not a revising body like RS, only a "dilatatory	Dimension 4 / advisory chamber."

STATIC THEORY

- Money bill only in the **Assembly**; Council **only recommends**, returns in **14 days**; **Speaker** certifies.
- Ordinary bill: Council can only **delay 4 months** (3 + 1) → **not a revising body like RS, only a "dilatatory
- / advisory chamber."**
- Council can't vote demands for grants; **can't pass a no-confidence motion** (CoM responsible only to Assembly).
- Council **doesn't** vote in President's election / RS elections; **no effective say** in ratifying
- constitutional amendments; its very **existence depends on the Assembly**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Equal:** ordinary bills, ordinance approval, choosing ministers/CM, considering constitutional-body reports. **Unequal (Assembly dominates):**

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C —
COUNCIL vs ASSEMBLY (the key contrast) □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — COUNCIL vs ASSEMBLY (the key contrast) □ · Part 2

GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□□ Council is **much weaker than the Rajya Sabha** (RS reflects the federal element; Council has no federal role and a heterogeneous composition). Critics: "costly ornamental luxury", "white elephant". Utility: checks hasty legislation + represents experts.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C —
COUNCIL vs ASSEMBLY (the key contrast) □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: All states have a Legislative Council

CORRECT: only **6** are **bicameral**.

WRONG: Creating/abolishing a Council is a constitutional amendment

CORRECT: passed by Parliament by **simple majority** (Art 169), on the Assembly's special-majority resolution.

WRONG: The Council is a revising body like the Rajya Sabha

CORRECT: only a **dilatory chamber** (delays ordinary bills max **4 months**).

WRONG: Council can reject a money bill

CORRECT: only **recommends**, returns in **14 days**.

WRONG: Council members are directly elected

CORRECT: **5/6 indirectly elected + 1/6 nominated** by the Governor.

WRONG: Max Council strength = 1/3 of Assembly, min 60

CORRECT: **min 40**.

WRONG: Council can remove the CoM by no-confidence

CORRECT: **no** (CoM responsible only to the **Assembly**).

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH**Advanced • CA hooks****GS-II Indian
Polity****NEWS TRIGGER**

□ □ □ Periodic **demands to create/abolish Councils** (e.g. proposals in Rajasthan, Odisha, Assam; earlier the WB & TN revival debates) — recurring Art 169 questions. □ □ **Post-2026 census and delimitation** — readjustment does not begin automatically in 2026; it

INTRO & ORIGIN

awaits publication of relevant figures from the first census taken after 2026 and will affect Assembly seats as well as the women's-reservation sequence.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Are Legislative Councils a "costly ornamental luxury" or a valuable revising chamber? Discuss. Should the composition of Legislative Councils (graduate/teacher constituencies) be reformed?

STUDY LINK

State Legislature (Articles 168–212) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI